



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's learn about a Chinese system of organization!



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Where is your room?
- What do you do to keep things organized in your room?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about healthy habits.
- I can talk about rooms and objects in them.
- I can talk about what people do or what people are doing.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa reads about Feng Shui. Will she become a Feng Shui **practitioner***?

* A "practitioner" is someone who regularly does a particular activity.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

More people are practicing Feng Shui in the western world. The ancient Chinese began using Feng Shui because they believed that their home's surroundings, including its decor and furnishings, can be arranged to promote harmony. They believe that a home's physical environment has its own energy, or "chi". When you place objects in the right area, the chi flows and promotes a sense of well-being.

Feng Shui is quite practical. For example, an ideal position for your bed is against a wall where you can see the whole room and the door. In order to feel secure, it is a good idea to have a sturdy headboard which protects your head when you are sleeping.

Also, Feng Shui suggests that side tables should be lower than your mattress. This makes sense because you will not bang your head against the sharp edges of the side table when you are sleeping. Sharp edges next to your head do not promote a restful night's sleep.

Feng Shui helps us find the ideal place for all of the objects in our home.





Let's Practice!

What's in Vanessa's room*?

*When you talk about someone's "room", you are talking about their bedroom.

Instructions: Read the sentence or word in Column A. Match the sentence or word with its definition in Column B.

Column A

1. decorative items in a room
2. decor
3. panel at top of bed
4. side table
5. what you lie on
6. energy

Column B

- a. mattress
- b. furnishings
- c. chi
- d. room style
- e. headboard
- f. table beside a bed



Let's Practice!

Vanessa thinks about the article she read.

Instructions: Write the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

_____ is an ancient Chinese system of balancing your physical environment to promote _____ and a sense _____.

Practitioners believe that everything has a certain energy, or _____, and how you arrange those objects can affect all aspects of our lives.

On a practical level, that means there's an _____ place for every object.

If you do not feel _____ in your bedroom, change your headboard to something more _____.

If you have side tables next to your bed, they should not have sharp edges. The sharp corners next to your head will keep you from _____ while sleeping.

Word Bank

- optimal
- chi
- sturdy
- Feng Shui
- of well-being
- secured or
- harmony
- total relaxation
- grounded



Extension Activity

Let's Feng Shui your bedroom!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go on the Internet.
- Do some research about Feng Shui.
- Make a list of different ways to Feng Shui your bedroom.
- Look at your list. Do you do any of them?
- Choose 3-4 ways you could Feng Shui your room.
- Write down why you chose them.
- Try one of them out.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I can talk about Feng Shui.

☐
☐

I write about different ways to Feng Shui my bedroom.

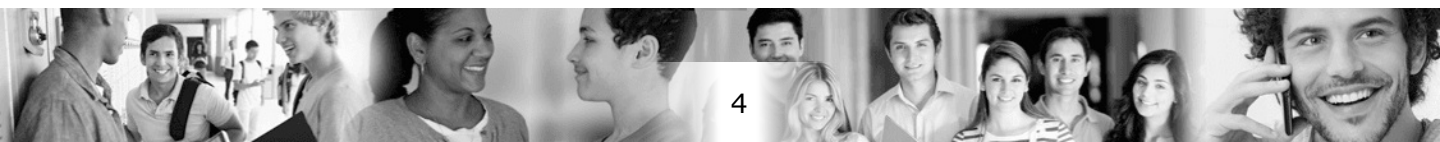
☐
☐

I write about my bedroom and objects in it.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **furnishings** (noun): the furniture and other things, such as curtains, in a room
e.g. They believed that their home's surroundings, including its decor and furnishings, can be arranged to promote harmony.
- **decor** (noun): the way that the inside of a room is decorated
e.g. The decor in your bedroom should be soothing.
- **headboard** (noun): the upright board at the end of a bed where your head is
e.g. It is a good idea to have a sturdy headboard which protects your head when you are sleeping.
- **side table** (noun): a table designed to be placed beside a bed
e.g. Feng Shui suggests that side tables should be lower than your mattress.
- **mattress** (noun): the soft part of a bed that you lie on
e.g. The mattress on my bed is huge.





Learning Points

What is Feng Shui?

Feng Shui (pronounced fung shway) is a Chinese way of arranging all objects, including furniture, in a home or building so that good fortune and well-being are present.

Feng Shui states that chi (energy) lives in all things. This energy is made up of two opposite forces, yin (female) and yang (male). There are five elements in Feng Shui: fire, water, metal, earth and wood. A balance must always be present among the elements.

When you place furniture and objects with the principles of Feng Shui in mind, you can use a compass (or a bagua) so the objects are in the correct direction.

Simple Present and Present Continuous

You use Simple Present to talk about facts and healthy habits.

Examples:

- *Feng Shui helps us find the ideal place for all of the objects in our home.*
- *Everything has a certain energy.*

You use Present Continuous to talk about temporary activities.

Example:

- *More people are practicing Feng Shui in the western world.*

